

Detailed Report on Government Schemes for Artisans, Craftspeople, Sculptors, and Traditional Workers in India (2026)

Executive Summary

India has more than 7 million artisans and craftspeople engaged in handicrafts, handlooms, sculpture, pottery, metal crafts, wood carving, tribal arts, and other traditional occupations. The Government of India has launched multiple schemes to preserve cultural heritage and improve livelihoods.

1. PM Vishwakarma Scheme (2023–2028)

Flagship scheme for traditional artisans launched on 17 September 2023. Total budget allocation: ₹13,000 Crore.

Eligible Trades (18 Categories)

Sl No	Trade
1	Carpenter
2	Boat Maker
3	Armourer
4	Blacksmith
5	Hammer & Tool Kit Maker
6	Locksmith
7	Goldsmith
8	Potter
9	Sculptor/Stone Carver
10	Cobbler
11	Mason
12	Basket/Mat/Broom Maker
13	Doll & Toy Maker

14	Barber
15	Garland Maker
16	Washerman
17	Tailor
18	Fishing Net Maker

2. National Handicrafts Development Programme (NHDP)

Focuses on sustainable livelihood, cluster development, and export promotion through components like Ambedkar Hastshilp Vikas Yojana (AHVY), design workshops, and the Guru Shishya Hastshilp Prashikshan Programme.

3. Handicrafts Artisan's Comprehensive Welfare Scheme

Provides social security, including health insurance (₹1 lakh coverage), accidental insurance (₹2 lakh), and maternity benefits.

4. Additional Key Schemes

- **Comprehensive Handicrafts Cluster Development Scheme (CHCDS):** Infrastructure development for large artisan clusters.
- **Pehchan Scheme:** Provides Artisan Identity Cards for access to welfare benefits.
- **SFURTI:** Cluster development for traditional industries.
- **ODOP (One District One Product):** District-specific branding and marketing support.
- **MUDRA Loans:** Credit up to ₹10 lakh for business expansion.

Challenges and Recommendations

Challenges: Dependency on middlemen, limited digital literacy, lack of direct market access, and raw material cost inflation.

Recommendations: Implementation of a universal artisan database, AI-enabled marketplaces, blockchain for authenticity, and integration with ONDC.